moderation. That would also explain the overall silence of official Israeli sources. But how long can this go on?

There is another possible explanation: Netanyahu managed to prove that Iran masterminded the Hamas attack and has convinced Biden that this is the moment to strike Tehran, and thereby put an end to various annoyances in the Middle East (Hamas, Hezbollah) and reestablish the predominance of Western influence in the Arab world. It would be a step fraught with dangers, as the ayatollahs of the region will assuredly not go down without a fight. This in itself could explain the American reinforcements, at all levels. Orna holds this bold but logical interpretation. It is quite convincing, except for the risks involved, which do not fit with Netanyahu's usual modus operandi.

Monday, October 9

An estimated 800 Israelis killed. Otherwise, no sign of any major operation. Chaos on the roads: it takes hours for reservists to join their units.

It seems that Abbas Kamel, the Egyptian minister of intelligence, warned Netanyahu a few days before the assault that a major attack from Gaza was imminent; Netanyahu reportedly responded that the army was busy in the Occupied Territories. Indeed, the army was busy "protecting" Rachel's Tomb, as requested by Ben-Gvir and Smotrich. Kamel was supposedly stunned by the prime minister's indifference. If these reports of Egypt's warning turn out to be true, Netanyahu's responsibility is even heavier than previously thought. Netanyahu's office is calling it "fake news." Obviously.

Today I received a copy of my book, a German edition of this very diary, covering January to July 2023: *Blick in den Abgrund. Ein israelisches Tagebuch.* In English: "Gaze into the abyss: An Israeli diary." If, as I hope, I continue this diary to the conclusion of the war, I will strongly recommend its publication in a single volume. The early months do not explain what